Colorado State Forest Service Financial Assistance Program
Attachment A: Scope of Work

Project Name: #35 Castle View Forest Restoration Project
CSFS Account Number: 1929415

Work to be completed/deliverables:

Project Summary

This project will be administered by CSFS foresters and involves 700 acres of forest restoration treatments to reduce hazardous fuels and promote forest health across 5 landowners and 1 school district properties outside of Bailey, CO.

Prescription

Forest Stewardship Plans (FSP) were developed for three of the private landowners by the CSFS Golden Field Office who will be administering the project and developing prescriptions for the other treatment areas as well. The FSPs include a forest inventory that was conducted across the project area to assess forest conditions, develop management recommendations, and guide forest management across the project area. Four broad forest types were identified: dry-mixed conifer, ponderosa pine, lodgepole pine, and spruce-fir. Those forest types were further divided into seven different operable stands that vary greatly in terms of species composition, structure, forest health, basal area, and understory.

Lodgepole pine is in especially poor condition and will be targeted for removal. Most of the tree regeneration present is Douglas-fir indicating that more desirable species like ponderosa pine are not regenerating in the shade of this overstocked forest. Furthermore, Douglas-fir has filled in much of the forest connecting crowns and creating vertical continuity of fuel and will be heavily thinned to create openings and break up the vertical and horizontal fuel continuity. Opening the canopy and removing a significant proportion of trees in the midstory and understory will provide an opportunity for shade intolerant species like aspen and ponderosa pine to regenerate. Increased sunlight on the forest floor will also increase growth of grasses and forbs which enhances wildlife habitat.

The principles outlined in GTR 373 will be followed to create a groupy-clumpy spatial distribution where appropriate in dry-mixed conifer stands. Theoretically, the residual stands should be able to support broadcast burning or a wildfire event with limited mortality. Over 440 acres were successfully broadcast burned in the nearby Payne Gulch proving the viability of prescribed fire in this area. While the majority of snags will be removed to reduce fuel loading, viable wildlife trees will be identified and protected.

Post-treatment basal area goals will range from 0 in dense lodgepole stands to 80 in riparian areas.

CSFS Home Ignition Zone guidelines will also be followed to protect the residents' structures, ingress, and egress from wildfire. This will be the primary goal for the Windy Peak Outdoor Lab campus to help protect student and staff cabins from fire. Where present, streamside management zones will be protected in accordance to Colorado Best Management Practices.

Utilization & Slash Management Plan

The Colorado State Forest Service Golden Field Office's contracts require the contractor to utilize saw logs, fire wood, and biomass. Merchantable logs will be removed from the project area and utilized as sawlogs, while non-merchantable material will be utilized when economically and operationally viable. Slash will be masticated, piled and burned, lopped and scattered on slopes exceeding 40%, chipped and hauled, and/or removed using other methods as appropriate.

Budget Details
Award: $775,000
Match: $830,000 (51.71%)
Approved budget items include contractual costs to complete the fuels reductions work. Personnel/labor and supplies/materials will be used as match. Indirect costs are not part of the budget.

Milestone dates:
With a landscape-scale project this large, it will take several years and multiple projects to complete. For example, the second phase will be laid out while the first phase is being cut so there are multiple, consecutive phases over the grant period.

Year 1 (2024)
- Finalize funding
- Layout and contract development for phase 1
- By the end of the year, the goal is to have part of the project area under contract.

Year 2 (2025)
- Layout and contracting for phase 2
- 200 acres complete with reimbursement paperwork completed

Year 3 (2026)
- Post-treatment monitoring and weed-control for phase 1
- Layout and contracting for phase 3.
- 250 more acres complete with reimbursement paperwork completed

Year 4 (2027)
- Post-treatment monitoring and weed-control for phase 2
- 250 acres complete
- Project closeout and reimbursement paperwork completed

Project Completion deadline: **April 1, 2028**
Final Report and reimbursement request due to local CSFS Field Office: **May 1, 2028**

Standards or Guidelines: Best Management Practices must be followed for all forest management/fuels mitigation work completed under this award. Refer to the handbook *Forestry Best Management Practices to Protect Water Quality in Colorado* for more information.

- CSFS guidelines for Defensible Space and Fuelbreaks
- Principles & Practices for Restoration of Ponderosa Pine & Dry Mixed-Conifer Forests of the Colorado Front Range (gtr 373)
- Forest Restoration in the Southwest (gtr 310)
- To Masticate or Not: Useful Tips for Treating Forest, Woodland, and Shrub Vegetation (gtr 381)
- Mulching: A Knowledge Summary and Guidelines for Best Practices on Colorado's Front Range

All work completed under this award must be certified as meeting minimum Colorado State Forest Service standards prior to any reimbursement being made to the award recipient. CSFS Grant Reimbursement Request Package will be used to both request reimbursement and to certify that work has been completed to minimum standards.